

Statistics 154 / 254: Statistical machine learning

UC Berkeley, Fall 2026

Instructors



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i Note

Note that (due to HVAC problems) lectures will now be held in Lewis 100, starting immediately, for the foreseeable future.

This website will contain lecture materials and assignments. Day-to-day announcements and discussion will be found in ED. (See links above.)

Materials

The course will be based largely on [Lecture notes](#). The notes can be supplemented using subsets of the following texts:

- [Patterns, predictions, and actions: A story about machine learning](#) Hardt, Recht
- [ESL: The Elements of Statistical Learning](#) Hastie, Tibshirani, Friedman
- [ISL: An Introduction to Statistical Learning](#) James, Witten, Hastie, Tibshirani

Additional reading will supplement these texts as necessary.

Some other good sources of reading material are:

- [Understanding Machine Learning: From Theory to Algorithms](#) Shalev-Shwartz, Ben-David
- [Probabilistic Machine Learning: An Introduction](#) Murphy
- [Dive into Deep Learning](#) Many authors

Schedule

Lectures will be held Aug 27th 2026 – Dec 3rd 2026 from 3:30pm – 5pm (starting at Berkeley time, 3:40pm) in **Lewis 100**.

Labs will be held on Mondays from

- 9am–11am (Gateway B1026)
- 4pm–6pm (Gateway B1012)
- 11am–1pm (Gateway B1023)
- 1pm–3pm (Gateway B1023)

The [official course catalog entry](#) is the ground truth for scheduling. If the catalog conflicts with this webpage, please notify the instructor and trust the catalog.

The tentative week-by-week course calendar is as follows. **The following schedule is aspirational and subject to change as we go.**

According to the [official schedule](#), the final exam has not been scheduled yet .

Table 1: Calendar (tentative)

Date	Day	Note	Unit	Topic	Assign- ment
Aug 27	Thurs- day	Lecture	Course policies		
Aug 31	Monday	Lab			Python review
Sep 1	Tuesday	Lecture	Unit 0: Introduction and review		
Sep 3	Thurs- day	Lecture			HW 0
Sep 7	Monday	Adminis- trative holiday	Unit 1: Regression		
Sep 8	Tuesday	Lecture			
Sep 10	Thurs- day	Lecture			Quiz 0
Sep 14	Monday	Lab			Chal- lenge 1
Sep 15	Tuesday	Lecture			
Sep 16	Wednes- day	Add / drop deadline			

Date	Day	Note	Unit	Topic	Assignment
Sep 17	Thursday	Lecture	Unit 2: Classification		
Sep 21	Monday	Lab			Challenge 1
Sep 22	Tuesday	Lecture			
Sep 24	Thursday	Lecture			HW 1
Sep 28	Monday	Lab			Oral Exam 1
Sep 29	Tuesday	Lecture	Unit 3: Risk and Complexity		
Oct 1	Thursday	Lecture			Quiz 1
Oct 5	Monday	Lab			Reading 1
Oct 6	Tuesday	Lecture			
Oct 8	Thursday	Lecture			HW 2
Oct 12	Monday	Lab	Unit 4: Trees and weak learners		Challenge 2
Oct 13	Tuesday	Lecture			
Oct 15	Thursday	Lecture			Quiz 2
Oct 19	Monday	Lab			Oral Exam 2
Oct 20	Tuesday	Lecture			
Oct 22	Thursday	Lecture	Unit 4: Trees and weak learners		
Oct 26	Monday	Lab			Challenge 3
Oct 27	Tuesday	Lecture			
Oct 29	Thursday	Lecture			HW 3
Nov 2	Monday	Lab			Challenge 3
Nov 3	Tuesday	Lecture			
Nov 5	Thursday	Lecture			Quiz 3

Date	Day	Note	Unit	Topic	Assignment
Nov 9	Monday	Lab			Oral Exam 3
Nov 10	Tuesday	Lecture			
Nov 11	Wednesday	Administrative holiday			
Nov 12	Thursday	Lecture			
Nov 16	Monday	Lab			Challenge 4
Nov 17	Tuesday	Lecture	Unit 5: Neural networks and optimization		
Nov 19	Thursday	Lecture			HW 4
Nov 23	Monday	Lab			Challenge 4
Nov 24	Tuesday	Lecture			
Nov 25	Wednesday	Thanksgiving			
Nov 26	Thursday	Thanksgiving			
Nov 27	Friday	Thanksgiving			
Nov 30	Monday	Lab			Oral Exam 4 Quiz 4 HW 5
Dec 1	Tuesday	Lecture			
Dec 3	Thursday	Lecture	Class review		